gurudwaras were still functioning from residential buildings, school complexes, and so on. Although a number of gurudwaras had come up in smaller towns around Toronto, the main gurudwara was run out of a building at 269, Pape Avenue, off Gerard Street, purchased in 1968 by the Shiromani Sikh Society.

The managements of gurudwaras in Canada were typical of the managements of gurudwaras in Punjab. The functioning of gurudwaras in the smaller cities faced no problems. But the growth of the community's population resulted in factionalism, rivalries, assertion of supremacy and feelings of revenge amongst groups in the more prominent gurudwaras. There was a joke doing the rounds amongst the local Sikhs that it was difficult to build the first gurudwara but the second one came soon thereafter. This meant that the faction that was not able to control a particular gurudwara would soon build another one in the same city. Older gurudwaras such as the Ross Street one in Vancouver were gradually shedding their traditional liberalism and were moving towards orthodoxy. From being venues of weekly or monthly jormelas (social gatherings) of Hindus and Sikhs, they were gradually exclusively catering to Sikh religious orthodoxy, thereby discouraging Hindus from participating in such gatherings.

With the establishment of gurudwaras came granthis (readers of sacred scriptures), ragis (singers of sacred hymns) and sewadars (caretakers) from India, courtesy of some senior Akali Dal leaders or members of the SGPC. They carried their convictions and prejudices with them, which started rubbing off on some Sikhs, especially of the older generation. But two things were common to all gurudwaras in Canada till the end of 1979: the idea of Khalistan was totally alien to them, and Bhindranwale was a complete nonentity.

Pape Avenue Gurudwara in Toronto had its own problems related to the election of its management committee. There were no fixed electoral rolls. Anybody from the neighbouring areas could come and cast his or her vote. There were several groups among the community. At one end of the spectrum were the Viveki Sikhs – the righteous or the puritans – and at the other were members of the Hardial Bains-led Communist Party of Canada (Marxist-Leninist) –